This warming recipe is based on a French country soup and is delicious topped with a spoonful of pesto, some chopped fresh parsley or tarragon, or some grated Parmesan.

allotment soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS WITHOUT THE GREEN BEANS

3oz (85g) French beans
2 tbsp olive oil
1 medium leek, finely sliced
1 small turnip, cut into ½in (1cm) dice
2 medium carrots, cut into ½in (1cm) dice
1 large zucchini, cut into ½in (1cm) dice
1 celery rib, cut into ½in (1cm) dice
1 large potato, cut into ½in (1cm) dice
2 tomatoes, peeled and cut into ½in (1cm) dice
2 garlic cloves, finely chopped
2 quarts (2 liters) cold water
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
6oz (175g) green beans, cut into ¾in (2cm) lengths

1 Put the French beans in a saucepan with plenty of cold unsalted water. Bring to a boil, cover with a lid, and boil for 15 minutes. Lower the heat, then simmer until tender and drain.

2 Meanwhile, heat the oil in a large saucepan, add the leek, turnip, carrots, zucchini, celery, potato, tomatoes, and garlic, and cook, stirring often, for 10–15 minutes or until they are soft but not brown. Add the water, season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then bring to a boil, cover with a lid, and simmer for 45 minutes or until all the vegetables are tender.

3 Add the cooked French beans to the pan along with the green beans, and cook for 5 minutes or until tender. Divide the soup among six bowls and serve with some crusty bread.